



1947–2011 · Israeli physicist and business consultant.

"An hour saved off a non-bottleneck is a mirage."

THE WHY THAT DROVE THE WORK

Goldratt argued that every system has a single binding constraint, and that improving anything other than the constraint is an illusion of progress.

INTELLECTUAL FOUNDATION

His Theory of Constraints, dramatised in the business novel *The Goal*, reframed operations around identifying and exploiting the bottleneck that governs throughput.

FRAMEWORKS ANCHORED IN THIS COURSE

He anchors Throughput Accounting in Unit 2's productivity-gains Slibrary.

HOW THE IDEAS OPERATIONALISE

His method operationalises as the five focusing steps: identify, exploit, subordinate, elevate and then repeat at the next constraint.

LIMITATIONS & CRITIQUE

The single-constraint assumption can oversimplify systems with multiple interacting bottlenecks, and throughput accounting sits uneasily beside conventional cost accounting.

ENDURING IMPACT

The Theory of Constraints reshaped operations management and project management, and *The Goal* remains a widely taught business text.

ON THE SAME PANEL (UNIT 2)

Erik Brynjolfsson · Giant 6

Robert Solow · Giant 7

Everett Rogers · Giant 8

Dave McClure · Giant 10

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Goldratt, E.M. (1984) *The Goal*. Great Barrington: North River Press.

Goldratt, E.M. (1990) *Theory of Constraints*. Great Barrington: North River Press.